

Final Year Individual Research project

- Average 900 hours of work
- Complete End August 2026
- 10,000 words (minimum) thesis excluding Reference list and Appendix
- Minimum 10 pages of project proposal
- 30 minutes presentation for the proposal defense
- 45 minutes presentation for final

Key stages of a research

- **Title:** The title of the project, should not exceed 15 words
- **Research Problem:** The description of the problem which the student is going to solve from the research project.
- **Research Questions and Research Objectives.** Questions derived from research problem and specific objectives to find answers to those questions.
- **Introduction:** Background to the study. A summary of the key relevant literature, references, or needs analysis that justifies the project, Significance of the research
- **Methodology:** A more detailed outline (sometimes called 'project protocol') of the actual research, data collection, analysis, design, implementation and evaluation.
- **Time Frame:** A timetable or plan of the key activities or stages of the project
- **Ethical concerns (if applicable):** An appreciation of any ethical issues raised and how they will be addressed
- **References:** Students should follow the IEEE style.

Originality of a research

originality means contributing new knowledge, insights, or solutions that are distinct from existing work.

clearly identify what makes your project unique—this could be a novel algorithm, an innovative system design, an unexplored application area, a new way to solve a problem, or improvements to existing methods.

Originality include :

Literature Review and Gap Identification: You must review existing research and technologies to highlight what has already been done and then articulate a gap or limitation that your project addresses.

Novel Contribution: The project should offer something new, such as creating a prototype with unique features, developing an original algorithm, or applying concepts in a new context.

Problem Definition: Clearly define the problem in a way that is distinct from previous work, showing why the new approach or design is needed.

Methodology and Implementation: Explain how the methods or approaches taken are innovative and differentiate the project from standard or common solutions.

Results and Impact: Demonstrate through evaluation, testing, or analysis how the project outcomes provide new insights, improved performance, or practical benefits.

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originality does not always mean inventing something entirely new—it can include applying known techniques creatively, combining existing ideas in new ways, or tailoring solutions to particular, underexplored problems.

How ICT research change from Social science research ?

Methodology

Description of the research approach, including system design, architectural models, algorithms, tools, programming languages, simulation setup, or frameworks used.

System Analysis and Design (if applicable)

Detailed documentation of system requirements, design diagrams (UML, flowcharts), and design decisions.

Implementation

Description of how the system, algorithm, or simulation was developed, including coding standards and development environment

Data Collection and Experimental Setup (if applicable)

Details on how data were collected, experimental design, simulation parameters, or real-world testing procedures.

Testing and Evaluation

Testing strategies (unit, integration, system), performance benchmarks, user feedback, or evaluation metrics with analysis of results.

Discussion

Interpretation of results, comparison with expectations or existing solutions, limitations observed.

Conclusion

Summary of findings, significance of the research, and confirmation of objectives met.

Recommendations and Future Work

Suggestions for extending the research, addressing limitations, or exploring related problems.

References

Comprehensive citation of all sources referred to.

Apendices:

Source code snippets, detailed data tables, user manuals, or supplementary materials